

By STEVE WESTON

Citizen Sportswriter

EL PASO — When coach Jerry Kindall's University of Arizona baseball team lost a game a few weeks ago in Tucson to Texas-El Paso's Miners, it was merely regrettable.

Another defeat could be disastrous.

And the Wildcats will go all out to avoid that tomorrow and Saturday as they take on coach Andy Cohen's Miners in a critical Western Athletic Conference Southern Division three-game series.

The set opens with an 11 a.m. (Tucson time) contest tomorrow. Righthander Dave Breuker will go to the mound for Arizona in an attempt to win his 13th game of the season without defeat.

Breuker probably will go up against UTEP's spunky junior righthander Roy Stringer (6-3, 3.75). Stringer was the winning pitcher in the Miners' 6-4 upset of the Cats and has hurled a win over Arizona State. Despite a bad shoulder, Stringer held ASU to a 3-2 victory just last weekend.

In Saturday's 9 a.m. (Tucson time) twin bill, UA will pitch righthanders Mark Schimpf (11-0) and Ron Bell (3-0) against UTEP righthanders Jeff Hogan (3-4) and Dan Modlinski (3-5).

As the WAC Southern Division is approaching the finish, Kindall's Wildcats cannot afford to stumble.

UA, No. 1 rated in the country, goes into the game 50-4 overall and 10-2 in conference play. But they are being hotly pursued by A-State (36-20, 9-3), which is at New Mexico tonight and tomorrow.